



Slides in response to P3655R2

Concerns regarding `std::zstring_view`

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Reply-To:

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Source:

github.com/Eisenwave/cpp-proposals/blob/master/src/zstring-view-slides.cow



IMPORTANT: This document has custom controls:

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Concerns regarding

`std::zstring_view`

P3655R2

Some obvious problems

- we have a lot of string types already; `std::zstring_view` makes it worse:
 `std::string, std::string_view, std::zstring_view,`
 `std::u8string, std::u8string_view, std::u8zstring_view, ...`
- `std::zstring_view` is a weird name with no precedent in C++ standard
 - `std::cstring_view` probably better

P3655R2 lacks discussion of performance

- Why not just `c_function(std::string(sv).c_str())`?
 - for short strings, can also dump into local `char[N]`
 - C APIs usually either take short strings, or also take sizes
 - e.g. `fopen` takes short string, `fwrite` takes `size_t`
- `std::zstring_view` only makes sense if ...
 - C API takes no `size_t`
 - function is called often enough to make "buffer spilling" in hot code
- `std::zstring_view` computes size, but does not pass to C API

std::zstring_view is a viral annotation

Preserving null terminators is not easy:

```
void c_api_wrapper(std::zstring_view s);

const zstring_view config_source = /* ... */;
map<string_view, string_view> config = json::parse(config_source);

c_api_wrapper(config.at("file")); // error
```

- zstring_view → ~~z~~string_view → zstring_view → C API ❌
- zstring_view → zstring_view → zstring_view → C API ✅

Suggestions to increase consensus

- explore alternative solutions more
don't handwave performance issues, provide numbers
- address viral annotation problems
how do existing libraries handle this?
- ~~std::zstring_view~~ std::cstring_view please